



restaurant

DROPOUT

SPRING RECIPES 2025



^{MINI} **THIS WEEK'S MENU**

BBQ Chopped Chicken Salad with Crispy Tortilla Strips & Cilantro Dill Crema

barbecue chicken, romaine lettuce, elote pico, cilantro dill crema, crispy tortilla strips, cilantro, barbecue sauce, avocado, sharp cheddar

Chicken en Salsita Tostadas with Refried Beans & Sour Cream

asadero salsa-braised chicken, crispy tostadas, refried beans, romaine lettuce, lime, cilantro, scallions, sour cream

Marinated Steak Platter with Corn Salsa, Avocado, Beans, & Tortillas

marinated steak, elote pico, avocado, lime, cilantro, scallions, refried beans, warm tortillas, sour cream, asadero salsa

PLUS IDEAS FOR...

Leftover Burritos

with Cheater Beans, Marinated Steak, Cheddar, & Asadero Salsa

BBQ Chicken Pizza

with BBQ Sauce, Cheddar Cheese, Grilled BBQ Chicken, Shallots, & Cilantro

Chicken en Salsita Flautas

with Braised Chicken en Salsita, Corn Tortillas, Sour Cream, & Lime



GROCERY LIST

Produce

- Shallot (1 small)¹³
- Garlic (5 cloves)²³
- Limes (4)¹²³
- Avocado (2)¹³
- Red Bell Pepper (1)¹³
- Jalapeño (1)¹³
- Romaine Lettuce (2-3 hearts)¹²³
- Dill (1 small bunch)¹
- Cilantro (1 bunch)¹²³
- Scallions (1 bunch)¹²³

Shelf-Stable Goods

- BBQ Sauce (Mesquite)¹
- Corn Tortillas (10-15)¹²
- Flour Tortillas (4)³
 - or additional Corn Tortillas
- 2 (15 oz) cans Whole Pinto Beans²³
- Peeled Tomatoes (14.5 oz can)²
- Tomato Sauce (8 oz)²
- Chicken Stock (1 cup)²

Frozen

- Fire-Roasted Corn (12 oz)¹³

Juice & Dairy

- Orange Juice, Pulp Free (11.5 fl oz)³
- Sour Cream¹²

Cheese

- Extra Sharp White Cheddar Cheese (8 oz)¹²³

Suggested Proteins

- 2 (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breasts¹²
- 1 lb Skirt or Flank Steak³

KEY

¹ = BBQ Chopped Chicken Salad

² = Chicken en Salsita Tostadas

³ = Marinated Steak Platter

*=rollover ingredient



ESSENTIALS

& ADDITIONAL MEALS

Essentials

Fats

- Olive Oil²³
- Neutral Oil¹²³

Acids & Vinegars

- White Wine Vinegar²³

Spices & Aromatics

- Black Pepper¹
- Chili Powder¹²³
- Paprika¹
- Garlic Powder¹
- Onion Powder¹
- Smoked Paprika¹
- Dried Oregano²
- Crushed Red Pepper Flakes²³
 - or Chiles de Japones²

Other

- Kosher Salt¹²³
- Brown Sugar¹
- All-Purpose Flour²³
- Soy Sauce³
- Honey³

KEY

¹ = BBQ Chopped Chicken Salad

² = Chicken en Salsita Tostadas

³ = Marinated Steak Platter

Green = Add if making Additional Meals

Additional Meals

Leftover Burritos

- Burrito-size Flour Tortillas (2)
- 1 (8-12 oz) NY Strip Steak
- Cheddar Cheese (+ 2 oz)
- Romaine
 - reserve 1 handful
- Avocado (remaining ½)
- OJ Marinade
 - prepare with Steak Platter³
- Cheater Beans
 - use ⅓ batch for recipes²³

BBQ Chicken Pizza

- Pizza Dough
- 1 (8-9 oz) Chicken Breast
- Shallot (remaining ½ large or 1 small)
- Cheddar Cheese (+ 4 oz)
- BBQ Spice Rub
 - use ½ batch for BBQ Salad¹

Chicken en Salsita Flautas

- 1 (8-9 oz) Chicken Breast
 - braised with Chicken en Salsita²
- Taco-size Corn Tortillas (6)
- Romaine
 - reserve 1 handful
- Lime (remaining ½)



PREP LIST

Easy

KEY

¹ = BBQ Chopped Chicken Salad

² = Chicken en Salsita Tostadas

³ = Marinated Steak Platter

 = used in "prepped ingredient"

 = estimated time

Green = keep out during prep

□ Prep Produce (30-45 minutes)

- Romaine Lettuce (wash, dry, & thinly chop)¹²³
- Bell Pepper (1; dice)
- Garlic (5 cloves; peel)
- Limes (1; slice in half  | 3; slice into wedges¹²³)
- Herbs
 - Cilantro (1 bunch; chop)¹²³
 - Scallions (1 bunch; chop)¹²³
 - Dill (1-2 bunches; roughly chop)
- Shallot (1 small [or ½ large]; finely dice)
- Jalapeño (1; dice)

□ Prepare Elote Pico (see PDF 'Elote Pico')¹³

CLEANING BREAK

□ Shred ALL Extra Sharp White Cheddar Cheese¹³

□ Prepare Sauces, Marinades, & Spice Rubs (35 minutes)

- OJ Marinade (see PDF 'OJ Marinade')³
- Cilantro Dill Crema (see PDF 'Cilantro Dill Crema')¹
- Asadero Salsa (see PDF 'Asadero Salsa')²
- BBQ Spice Rub (see PDF 'BBQ Spice Rub')¹

□ Prepare Cheater Beans (see PDF 'Cheater Beans')²³

□ Prepare Corn Tortillas (4-6; Tostadas² | 4-5; Crispy Tortilla Strips¹)

- See notes on Substack 'Additional Prep' for cooking instructions

OPTIONAL ADDITIONAL PREP

□ Chicken Breasts (2; butterfly [store breasts separately])¹²

□ Braise Chicken in Asadero Salsa (See PDF 'Chicken en Salsita Tostadas')²

**Store raw proteins in airtight bags in the freezer; The night before intended use, transfer to the refrigerator to thaw overnight



BBQ CHOPPED CHICKEN SALAD

WITH TORTILLA STRIPS & CILANTRO DILL CREMA

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



BBQ Spice Rub (Page 9)¹

Elote Pico (Page 5)¹³

Cilantro Dill Crema (Page 7)¹

BBQ Chicken

1 (8-9 oz) Boneless-Skinless Chicken Breast,
butterflied

1 batch of BBQ Spice Rub

High Smoke Point Neutral Oil

¼ cup Mesquite Barbecue Sauce, *for glazing*

BBQ Chopped Chicken Salad

2 heavy handfuls of thinly sliced Romaine Lettuce

½ batch Elote Pico

Cilantro, chopped

Scallions, sliced

½ cup shredded Extra Sharp Cheddar Cheese

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

1 batch Cilantro Dill Crema

Mesquite Barbecue Sauce, *to taste*

1 batch of Crispy Tortilla Strips*

1 Avocado, pitted, peeled, & sliced

1 Lime, sliced into 4 wedges

* 4 corn tortillas, thinly sliced into strips, and fried (as noted on Substack in 'Additional Prep Notes')

Instructions

Prepare the BBQ-Spiced Chicken

1. Preheat your grill to 400°F.
2. Pat the **chicken breast** dry and coat all sides with the **BBQ spice rub**.
3. Once the grill is preheated, lightly coat the grates with a **neutral, high-smoke point oil**, and place the seasoned chicken directly onto the grates.
4. Gently brush the chicken with **barbecue sauce** as it cooks. After 5-6 minutes of cooking, flip the chicken, and brush again with barbecue sauce. Cook for an additional 5-6 minutes, then flip one last time, and cook for 1-2 minutes (to briefly cook the glazed sauce on the chicken).
5. Once the internal temperature of the chicken reaches 165°F, transfer it to a plate and loosely cover with foil—rest for 5 to 10 minutes before dicing it into bite-sized pieces.

Hot Tip: Prepare the salad while the chicken rests.

Assemble the Chopped Salad

1. In a large mixing bowl, combine **romaine lettuce**, **elote pico**, **cilantro**, **scallions**, **cheddar cheese**, a pinch of **salt**, and **pepper**.
2. Dice the BBQ chicken into bite-sized pieces and stir it into the tossed salad.
3. Top the salad with **cilantro dill crema** and **barbecue sauce** to your liking, and garnish with **crispy tortilla strips**, **sliced avocado**, and **lime wedges**.
4. Before serving, squeeze the juice from all the lime wedges onto the salad and toss until combined.



CHICKEN EN SALSITA TOSTADAS

WITH REFRIED BEANS & SOUR CREAM

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Asadero Salsa (Page 8)²

Cheater Beans (Page 4)²³

Asadero-Salsa Braised Chicken

1 (8-9 oz) Boneless-Skinless Chicken Breast,
butterflied

Kosher Salt

Neutral Oil

1 cup Chicken Stock

2 cups of Asadero Salsa

Chicken en Salsita Tostadas

4-6 Tostadas

½ batch Cheater Beans, *reheated*

5-6 pinches of thinly sliced Romaine Lettuce

Cilantro, chopped

Scallions, sliced

Sour Cream, *for garnish*

1 Lime, cut into 4 wedges

Instructions

Braise Chicken

1. Season the butterflied **chicken breast** with a couple pinches of **kosher salt** on both sides—set aside to rest for 5 minutes before cooking.
2. Heat a few glugs of **neutral oil** in a medium saucepan over high heat. Once the oil is hot and shimmering, place the seasoned chicken breast into the pan. Sear for 3-4 minutes or until a golden brown crust forms. Flip the chicken and slowly pour over the **chicken stock** and **asadero salsa**. Once the chicken is fully submerged, cover the pan with a lid and reduce the heat to low. Cook for 18-20 minutes until the chicken is fully cooked—*the time will depend on the size and thickness of your butterflied chicken breast*. To test if your chicken is ready, try breaking up the chicken with a fork. If it tears easily, it's ready.
3. Preheat your oven to 375°F.
4. Once the chicken is braised, using two forks, shred the chicken. For finely shredded chicken, transfer the cooked chicken breast to a stand mixer bowl (*fitted with a paddle attachment*) and shred on low speed for 1-2 minutes. Transfer the shredded chicken back to the sauce and stir until fully combined.

Crisp Tostadas & Serve

1. Place **tostadas** on a sheet tray and bake in the preheated oven for 1-2 minutes to crisp up.
2. Spread a thin layer of reheated **cheater beans** across the top of each tostada. Using tongs, place enough asadero-salsa chicken to cover each tostada.
3. Top each tostada with a small pinch of **romaine, cilantro, scallions**, and a dollop of **sour cream**.
4. Plate and serve with **lime wedges** on the side.

MARINATED STEAK PLATTER

WITH CORN SALSA, AVOCADO, BEANS, & TORTILLAS

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

OJ Marinade (Page 6)³

Cheater Beans (Page 4)²³

Elote Pico (Page 5)¹³

Marinated Steak

1 lb Skirt or Flank Steak

Kosher Salt

1 batch OJ Marinade

High Smoke Point Neutral Oil

Platter

Remaining thinly sliced Romaine Lettuce

1 Avocado, pitted, peeled, & sliced

½ batch Elote Pico

1 Lime, sliced into 4 wedges

Scallions, sliced

Cilantro, chopped

½ batch of Cheater Beans, *reheated*

Shredded Extra Sharp White Cheddar Cheese

4 Taco-size Corn or Flour Tortillas, *reheated**

*See Substack 'A Few Quick Notes' for reheating instructions

Instructions

At least 1 hour before cooking...

Marinate the Steak

1. Generously season the **steak** on all sides with **kosher salt**—rest for about 5 minutes.
2. Place the seasoned steak in a shallow bowl and cover completely with the **OJ marinade**. Cover and marinate for at least 1 hour in the refrigerator (*or up to 24 hours in the refrigerator*).

Cook Steak & Serve

1. Preheat your grill to 400°F.
2. Once the grill is preheated, lightly coat the grill grates with a **neutral, high-smoke point oil**, and place the marinated steak directly onto the grates. Cook, searing both sides—4-5 minutes per side.
3. Check the internal temperature for doneness; 125°F-130°F will result in a medium-rare; 135°F-140°F will result in medium; 145°F-150°F will result in medium-well.
4. Once your steak reaches your desired level of doneness, transfer it to a cutting board and cover loosely with foil; rest for 5-10 minutes before slicing.
5. On a serving platter or extra-large plate, serve the sliced steak over a bed of **romaine**, and top with **sliced avocado**, **elote pico**, **lime wedges**, **scallions**, and **cilantro**.
6. In a separate platter (or plate), plate the reheated **cheater beans** and top with a pinch of **cheddar cheese**. Serve with **reheated tortillas**, wrapped in foil (to remain fresh).



CHEATER BEANS

Makes about 4 cups

Ingredients

2 Tbsp Olive Oil
1 Tbsp (8 g) Chili Powder
2 Tbsp (8 g) All-Purpose Flour
2 (15 oz) cans of Pinto Beans (liquid included)
Kosher Salt, to taste
 $\frac{3}{4}$ cup (84 g) Shredded Extra Sharp Cheddar

Instructions

1. Heat 2-3 tablespoons of **oil** in a small saucepan over medium heat. Once hot, add **chili powder** and stir. Saute for 30 seconds to 1 minute or until the chili powder becomes fragrant and slightly toasted. Add **flour** and whisk until no clumps remain.
2. Add the **beans (with liquid)** and stir. Using a masher or an immersion blender, blend the beans until mostly smooth, with only a few chunks remaining. Taste and season with **salt**, if needed (if they're tasting a bit bland, add a pinch of salt and stir).
3. Reduce the heat to simmer and cook for 10-15 minutes. Turn off the heat, add **cheese** and stir. The residual heat will melt the cheese into the beans.

To Store: Remove from heat and allow beans to cool before transferring to an air-tight container and storing in the refrigerator.

ELOTE PICO

Makes about 1 ½ cups

Ingredients

1 Tbsp Neutral Oil
1 small (or ½ large) Shallot, finely diced
A pinch of Kosher Salt, *plus more to taste*
1 Bell Pepper, diced
1 Jalapeño, diced
1 (12 oz) bag of Frozen Fire-Roasted Corn
¼ cup (10 g) chopped Cilantro
Juice of ½ a Lime (5 g)

Instructions

1. Heat **oil** in a pan on medium-high heat. Add **diced shallot** along with a pinch of **salt** and sauté for 1-2 minutes.
2. Once the diced shallot is translucent, add **bell pepper** and **jalapeño**. Cook for an additional 2-3 minutes, or until the bell peppers are tender (*they should be slightly soft but still have a bite to them*).
3. Remove the shallot-pepper mix from heat and transfer to a medium-sized mixing bowl. Add **frozen fire-roasted corn** and mix until everything cools completely.
4. Once cooled, add chopped **cilantro** and **lime juice**. Season with salt to taste.

To Store: Place in air-tight container and store in the refrigerator.

OJ MARINADE

Makes about 2 cups

Ingredients

1 (11.5 fl oz) bottle of Orange Juice (Pulp Free)
1 Tbsp (21 g) Honey
1 Tbsp (15 g) Soy Sauce
1 Tbsp (11 g) White Wine Vinegar
2 tsp (10 g) Kosher Salt
1 tsp (4 g) Chili Powder
½ tsp (1 g) Crushed Red Pepper Flakes
1 clove of Garlic

Instructions

1. Blend **all ingredients** until smooth and fully puréed.

To Store: Transfer to an airtight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use.

CILANTRO DILL CREMA

Makes about ¼ cup

Ingredients

¼ cup (60 g) Sour Cream
2 Tbsp (26 g) Water
2 tsp (2 g) chopped Dill
2 tsp 2 g) chopped Cilantro
¼ tsp (2 g) Kosher Salt

Instructions

1. In a small mixing bowl, combine **sour cream, water, chopped dill, chopped cilantro**, and a pinch of **kosher salt**. Stir until well combined.

To Store: Transfer to an airtight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use.

ASADERO SALSA

Makes about 3 cups

Ingredients

1 (14.5 oz) can of Whole Peeled Tomatoes
1 (8 oz) can of Tomato Sauce
4 cloves of Garlic
3 Tbsp (10 g) thinly sliced Scallions
1 Tbsp (2 g) chopped Cilantro
1 tsp (15 g) White Wine Vinegar
1 Tbsp (4 g) Crushed Red Pepper Flakes*
1 tsp (5 g) Kosher Salt, *plus more to taste*
A pinch of Dried Oregano

**if you have access, source crushed Chiles de Japones
(whole dried work, too, since we're blending them)*

Instructions

1. Place **all ingredients** in a blender and blend until mostly smooth. Taste and season with additional **salt**, if needed.

To Store: Transfer the sauce to a container and store it in the refrigerator—the flavor will get better with time.

BBQ SPICE RUB

Makes about 3 Tablespoons

Ingredients

2 tsp (10 g) Brown Sugar
2 tsp (5 g) Smoked Paprika
1 tsp (4 g) Kosher Salt
1 tsp (3 g) Chili Powder
1 tsp (3 g) Paprika
1 tsp (3 g) Garlic Powder
1 tsp (3 g) Onion Powder

Instructions

1. Add **all ingredients** to a bowl and mix until well combined.

To Store: Place in an air-tight container and store at room temperature.